

3.4.1 Using IPS to upgrade and install new applications

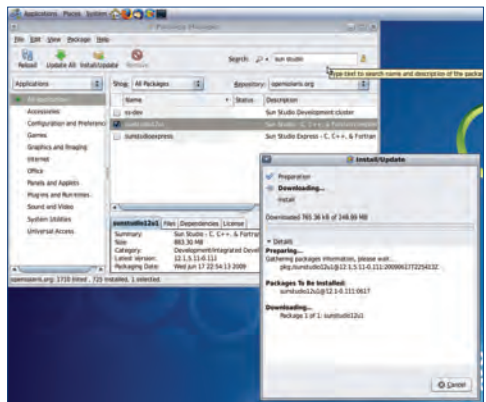
OpenSolaris since its first release, came up with a new Image Packaging System (IPS) for installing and managing applications. IPS provides a very simple interface to obtain new packages and update or remove existing packages. It can be accessed using both a GUI, and command line and also through the Firefox web browser!

Package management in Solaris is based on SVR4 style packages, which can be managed using utilities such as **pkgadd** and **pkgrm**. But it does not have a GUI and if an application has dependencies on other applications (it requires you to have some other application installed on your system before installing it) then resolving these dependencies can some time be difficult. IPS has many advantages, both for users as well as developers, which we will cover in this section. We will also show some examples of how to install SVR4 style packages using **pkgadd** utility.



All the user interface of Image Packaging Systems (IPS)

In order to install a new application using IPS, open the Package Manager by either clicking on Add More Software icon or clicking on System > Administration > Package Manager. Now you can use this GUI to search for packages and install them. The same GUI can be used to update or remove the packages as well.



Installing Sun Studio using Package Manager

Just search for a package